

# » THULASIMATHI MURUGESAN

**Category:** Badminton (Women's Singles SU5)

Hailing from a modest family in Kancheepuram, near Chennai, Thulasimathi Murugesan was born with a deformity in her left hand. Despite financial hardships, her father, Murugesan, a sports enthusiast, encouraged his daughters to pursue sports.

At 22, Thulasimathi became the first Indian female to reach a para-badminton final at the Paralympics, defeating compatriot Manisha Ramadass in the semifinals. She secured a silver medal in the SU5 category after a straight-game loss to Tokyo 2020 gold medallist Yang Qiu Xia of China.

Earlier, at the 2022 Asian Para Games in Hangzhou, she had won gold in women's singles. She also partnered with Nitesh Kumar to win bronze in mixed doubles SL3-SU5 and with Manasi Joshi to claim silver in women's doubles SL3-SU5. Thulasimathi and Manasi went on to secure another silver at the 2024 World Championships.



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# » SUHAS YATHIRAJ

**Category:** Badminton (Men's Singles SL4)

Suhas Yathiraj claimed a silver medal at the Paris Paralympics in the men's singles SL4 category, which is designated for athletes with impairments in one or both lower limbs and minimal difficulty in walking or running.

He narrowly missed out on gold, losing to France's Lucas Mazur in the final, marking his second consecutive silver after a similar result at the Tokyo Games. Suhas remains the only Indian para-badminton player to win back-to-back Paralympic medals.

Born with a congenital deformity in his left ankle, Suhas overcame physical challenges to pursue both his passion for badminton and a successful career as an IAS officer.

The 41-year-old's rise to prominence began with a gold medal at the 2016 Asian Para-Badminton Championships. He later won a bronze at the 2018 Asian Para Games, followed by a gold at the 2022 Asian Para Games.

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